THE ENGINEER'S BREAKDOWN

vylla

Well and septic: the pre-offer checklist

For any Connecticut home on a private well or septic. Do the **before you offer** column first, then write the inspections into your offer as contingencies.

BEFORE YOU OFFER

- [ ] Ask the seller's agent: well or public water? Septic or sewer?
- [ ] Ask for past water test results and septic pumping records
- [ ] Ask the age of the well, pump and septic system
- [ ] Request the septic permit file from the town or local health district
- [ ] Find where the well and tank are on the lot

PUT IN YOUR OFFER

- [ ] Water quality test contingency
- [ ] Well flow (yield) test contingency
- [ ] Septic inspection contingency
- [ ] Enough days to get lab results back
- [ ] Your remedy if a test fails: repair, credit or walk away

WATER QUALITY: WHAT CT DPH RECOMMENDS TESTING

- [ ] Basic indicators: total coliform bacteria, nitrate, nitrite, pH, odor, chloride, hardness, color, sulfate, turbidity, iron, manganese
- [ ] Lead at least once, more often with young children in the home
- [ ] Arsenic, uranium and radon at least once
- [ ] Volatile organic compounds (VOCs) at least once
- [ ] Use a state-certified lab certified for each test you order

WATER FLOW

- [ ] Flow (yield) test to see if the well keeps up with a household's daily use
- [ ] Ask about recent dry spells, pump replacements or running out of water
- [ ] Check the pressure tank and pump age

SEPTIC

- [ ] Tank pumped and inspected, with the inspector looking inside
- [ ] Leach field checked for wet spots, odor or lush green strips
- [ ] System size matches the bedroom count on the permit
- [ ] Get a written report you can share with your lender

Water-testing list from CT Department of Public Health, Private Drinking Water in Connecticut, Publication No. 24 (May 2013); confirm current guidance with your local health department. This checklist is general information, not a substitute for licensed well, septic and home inspectors.

Jaskaran Singh, REALTOR® @jaskaranrealtor
Call/Text (475) 400-0661 · jaskaranrealtor.com
English · Hindi · Punjabi · Urdu

Brokered by Vylla Home
CT Lic# RES.0820095
Equal Housing Opportunity